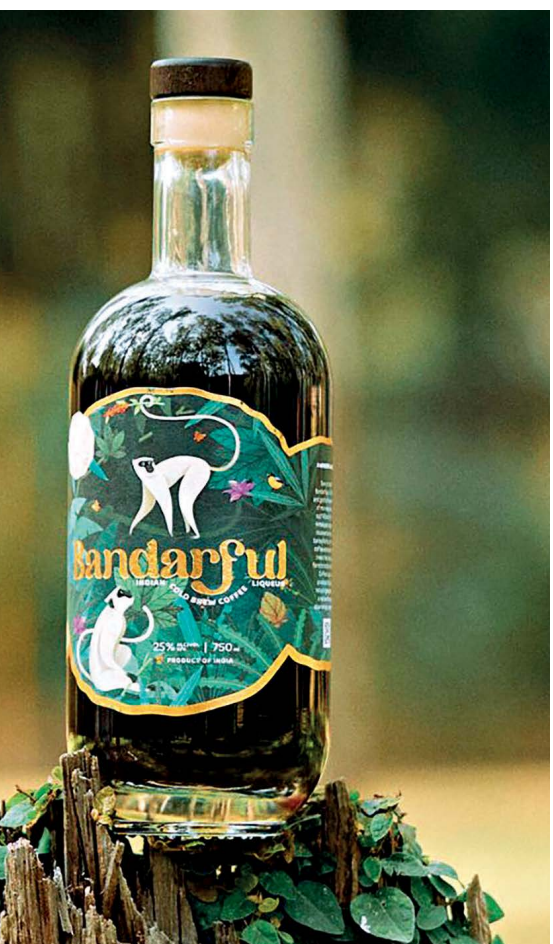




house had their own coffee bushes, and as a guest, you were not only served fresh, good coffee, you drank 'hosts' self-grown coffee'. The Portuguese took coffee to Brazil, which changed their culture and economy, and in return, brought cashew to Goa, which kindled the magnificent art of feni production, that's now synonymous with the state. He adds that after the second World War, instant coffee entered India, and people would simply add a sachet to their feni and drink it in the morning, coining the term 'Cafe Conserva'. "Coffee keeps changing with each harvest, so does feni. That's why we produce Cazulo Cafe Conserva in very small batches of, distilling it every 15-20 days, so that when you open the bottle, you're greeted with a hauntingly beautiful aroma". Now, would you say, it's just another bottle for your collection?

Price Goa ₹950 (750ml)

COFFEE COCKTAILS, ANYTIME

Espresso Martini was the most consumed cocktail during the COVID lockdown, and probably still is! Catching the momentum early on was the covid-baby, Mr. Jerry's Cocktails. These were pre-made, technically-sound cocktails, that barely needed any tools to whip out an impressive, consistent, gram-worthy concoction. Rincy Verghese shares "bartenders using coffee in their tipples is rather recent, and it has brought coffee to the fore. There's greater awareness about craft spirits, more disposable income, and experiential drinking. Coffee-accented tipples fit right in". Goa has the culture of going-out, and mingling with the community. During COVID, that couldn't happen and people were missing well-made drinks. That's where the idea stuck, and birthed Mr. Jerry's Cocktails. Even after the pandemic now, there are bars that wish to serve well-made cocktails, but don't necessarily have trained bartenders. "They have good food, good music, good service, but who's making good cocktails", questions Verghese. The chances are, when you're sipping a well made Espresso Martini on Goa's beaches or at a sleepy cafe, you're probably drinking Mr. Jerry's Cocktails Espresso Martini.

Price Goa: ₹650 (500ml priced) Delhi: ₹715; Maharashtra: V1,300; Karnataka: ₹1,300

NORTH MEETS SOUTH

Think of coffee and you're naturally drawn towards Southern India. Bandarful Himalayan Coffee Liqueur is not attempting to alter that, only add to it. In a way, it's a celebration of India's extraordinary terroir, by bringing together two of its most iconic landscapes: Chikmagalur's lush Arabica estates meets Kumaon's pure Himalayan spring water. "We also wanted a brand that felt joyful and expressive, hence the playful spirit of the Himalayan Langur, the "Bandar," that represents curiosity, freedom and adventure", explains Ansh Khanna, co-founder of Himmaleh Spirits. What makes it interesting is not just the name, the labelling, and the spirit in itself, but the thought that it provokes. Bandarful is an interesting way of telling the Indian story through the plethora of flavour, country's diverse offerings, and the craftsmanship it boasts of. But why not a coffee rum, or a coffee gin, I enquired. "Coffee liqueurs work brilliantly in cocktails, over ice, as digestifs, or even as dessert companions. This flexibility